

Mammals

Humans are warm-blooded mammals, but we share this group with thousands of other species. All mammalian mothers produce milk to feed their babies and most mammals are covered in fur.

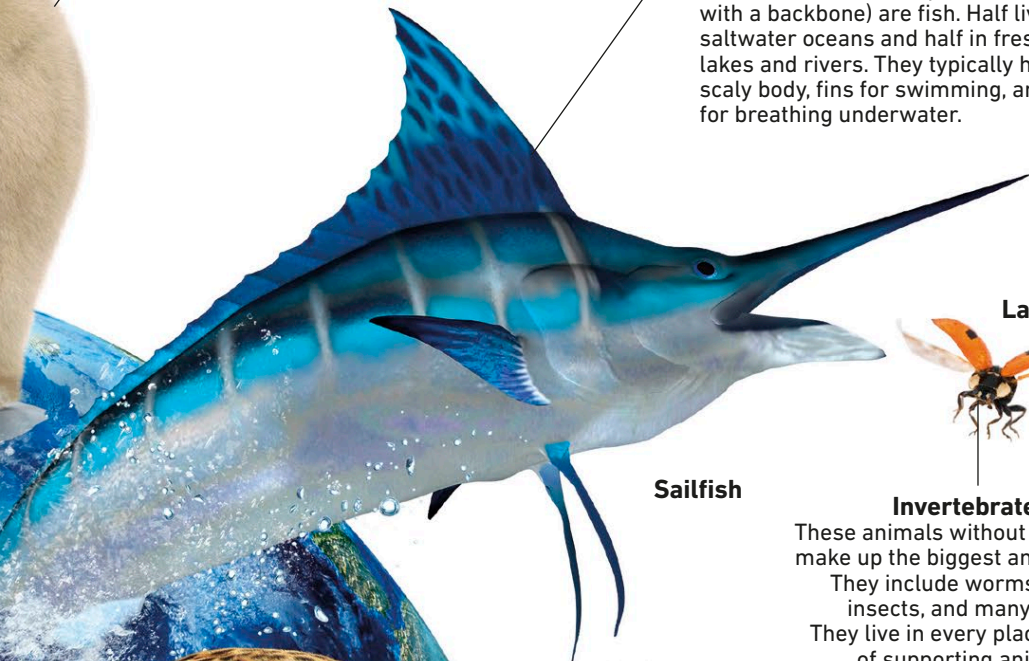
Fish

Half of all vertebrate species (animals with a backbone) are fish. Half live in saltwater oceans and half in freshwater lakes and rivers. They typically have a scaly body, fins for swimming, and gills for breathing underwater.

Ladybug



Sailfish

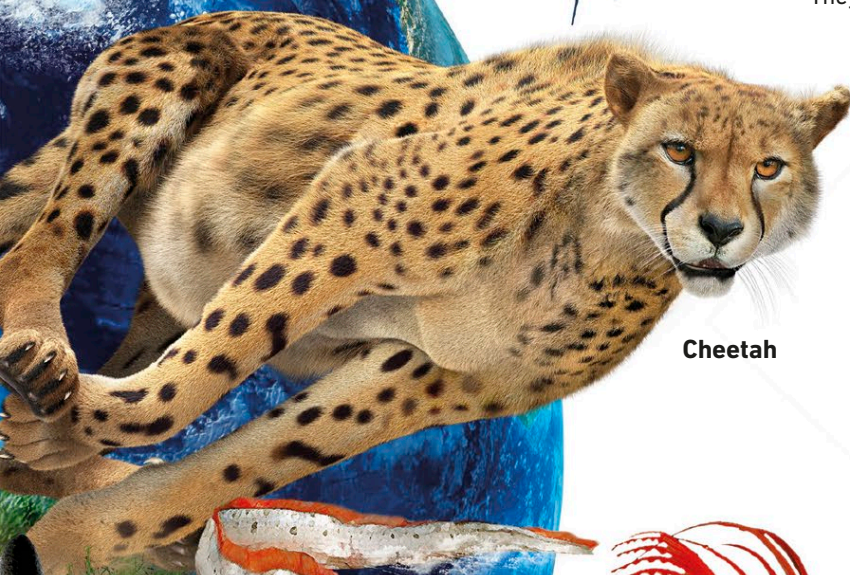


Invertebrates

These animals without a backbone make up the biggest animal group. They include worms, snails, insects, and many more. They live in every place capable of supporting animals.



Cheetah



Monarch butterfly

Oarfish



Amphibians

With their moist, scaleless skins, amphibians are mainly found in wet, freshwater habitats. They include frogs, toads, salamanders, newts, and worm-shaped caecilians.

California sea lion



Red-eyed tree frog

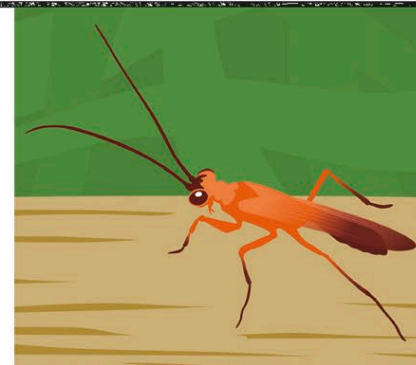


NEW SPECIES

Every year, scientists discover and name new species of animals found across the world, from forests to coral reefs. As exciting as these finds are, experts believe that approximately 90 percent of animal and plant species on Earth remain unknown. Listed below are some of the most recent amazing discoveries.

Wasp mantis

Found in the Peruvian Amazon in South America, this praying mantis has a body shape that makes it look like a stinging wasp. First described in 2019, it even moves and walks like a wasp, which helps to keep danger away.



Wakanda fairy wrasse

This purple-and-blue fish from an East African coral reef reminded the scientists who first described it of the outfit worn by Marvel's Black Panther. So in 2019 they named it Wakanda, after the superhero's fictional African kingdom.



Mini frogs

Scientists who discovered three tiny Madagascan frogs, each smaller than a fingernail, described them in 2019. The three species are some of the smallest frogs found in the world and were called *Mini mum*, *Mini scule* and *Mini ature*.



Salazar's pit viper

As fans of the Harry Potter books, the scientists who described this Indian snake in 2020 had a good option to name it. The venomous pit viper was named after the character Salazar Slytherin, who—in the story—could communicate with snakes.



Alor Myzomela

Sadly, by the time they are named some new species are already under threat of extinction. Described in 2019, this striking bird—a honeyeater—located in eucalyptus forests on the Indonesian island of Alor is threatened by deforestation.

